

Woodpeckers and toucans

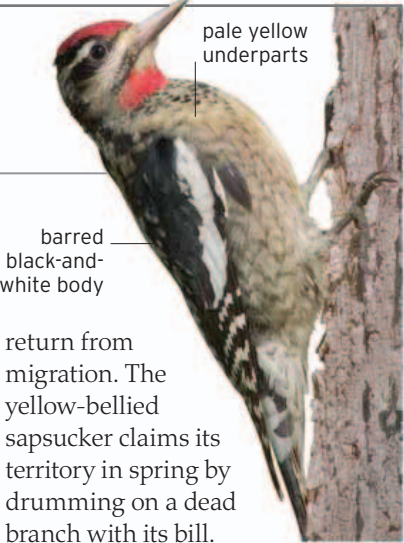
Order Piciformes

Yellow-bellied sapsucker

Sphyrapicus varius

- ↔ 9 in (23 cm)
- 📍 North and Central America, Caribbean Islands
- ⊗ Common

This species mainly eats sugary sap, which it obtains by drilling holes in the bark of trees such as maples and waiting for the sap to ooze out. It also snaps up any insects attracted by the sap. The holes may be tended to keep them open and renewed on



return from migration. The yellow-bellied sapsucker claims its territory in spring by drumming on a dead branch with its bill.

Chestnut-eared aracari

Pteroglossus castanotis

- ↔ 13–16 in (33–40 cm)
- 📍 N. to C. South America
- ⊗ Common

This relatively small toucan has a long, slim, gently curved bill with serrated edges and yellow markings resembling teeth. Its name refers to the brown patch behind each eye; otherwise it is mainly dark with yellow underparts and a red band across its chest. Small parties forage together in the forest canopy for insects and fruit, often hanging upside down from branches to reach it.

light build

Other species

- **Andean flicker**
Colaptes rupicola » p111
- **Black woodpecker**
Dryocopus martius » p169
- **Toco toucan**
Ramphastos toco » p96



Passerines

Order Passeriformes

Eurasian magpie

Pica pica

- ↔ 18 in (46 cm)
- 📍 Europe, NW. Africa, Middle East, C. and E. Asia
- ⊗ Common

Boldly pied in black and white, with a blue-purple sheen on its wings and a harsh, chattering call, the long-tailed Eurasian magpie is common and conspicuous across its wide range. It is an intelligent, resourceful bird

with a broad diet of small animals, carrion, bird eggs, fruit, and seeds. Notorious for being attracted to shiny objects, the magpie also has a reputation for stealing the eggs and nestlings of other birds, but this has been exaggerated. It is a territorial bird; it forms flocks after the breeding season and roosts in groups.



Carrion crow

Corvus corone

- ↔ 19–21 in (48–53 cm)
- 📍 Europe, W. and C. Asia
- ⊗ Common

The carrion crow and the similar hooded crow were once considered subspecies of the same bird, but have been reclassified as separate species. The carrion crow has a heavy black bill. Like many

crows, it is highly intelligent, exploiting a huge range of food resources—on coasts, for example, it drops shellfish onto rocks to crack them open. The crow lives in many habitats including woodland, moorland, farmland, and towns. Although usually seen alone or in pairs, it may feed in loose flocks in winter. A solitary nester, it usually makes its home in a tree, although cliff ledges are often used in mountainous areas.

Wilson's bird-of-paradise

Cicinnurus respublica

- ↔ 7 in (16 cm)
- 📍 Indonesia
- ⊗ Near threatened

Like all its relatives, this bird is renowned for the male's dazzling plumage. Its black and crimson back, emerald green breast, and

yellow neck patch contrast strikingly with the bare crown on its head, which is turquoise with a pattern of black lines. It also has a pair of spiral, wirelike tail feathers that it flicks when displaying to females.

